UNATTENDED RUNS

What unattended Claude Code does when the API says no

Capacity errors, usage limits and spend caps are three different problems. Each one behaves differently.

UNROLL THE DRAWING

SECTION 02 · THREE PROBLEMS

Not every 'no' behaves the same way

A 529 is not your usage limit and doesn't count against quota. Session and weekly limits are shared across all models. A 429 reporting a spend limit fails at once.

FIG. 2

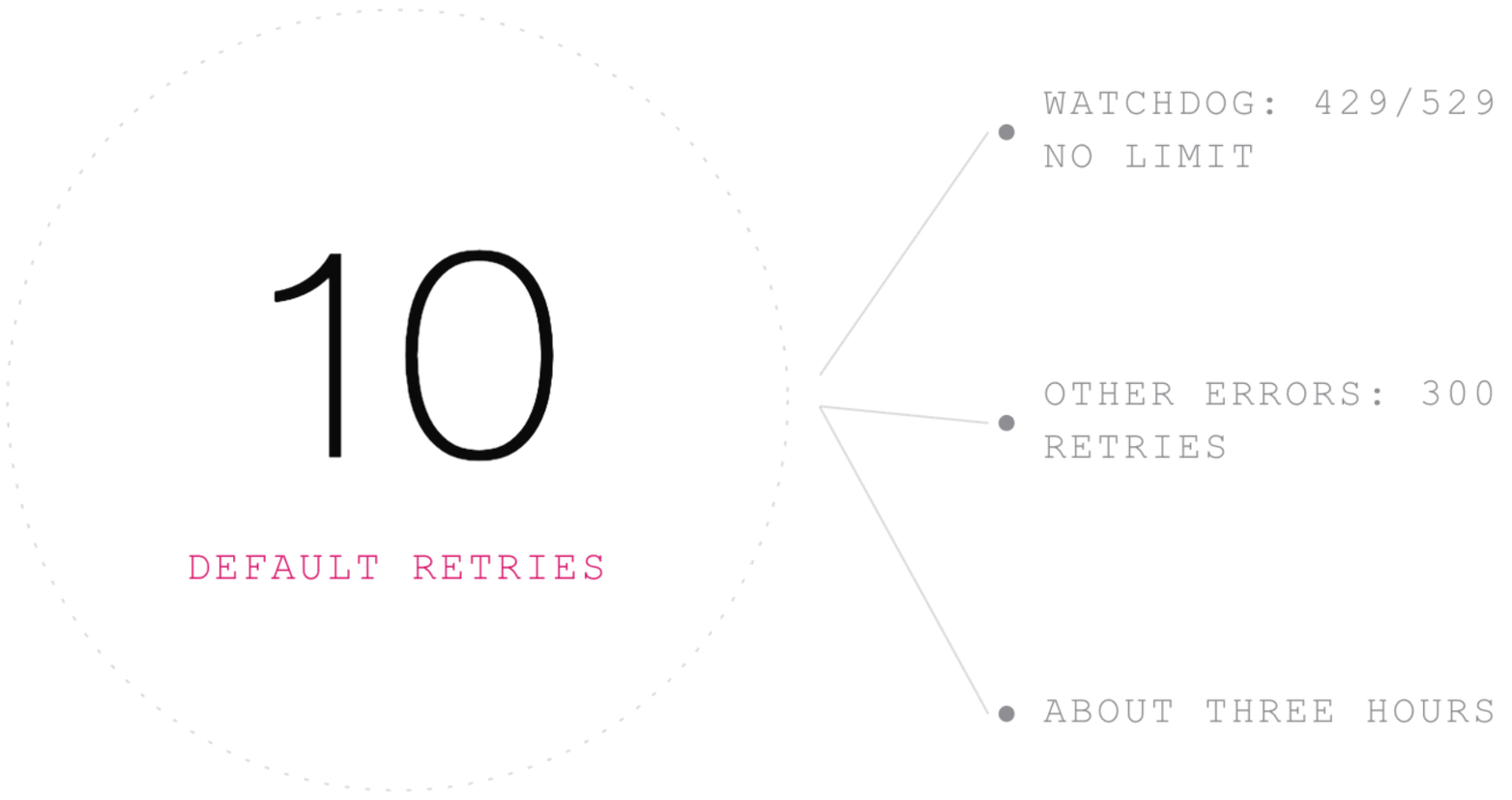


SECTION 03 · RETRY COUNTS

10 retries by default. The watchdog changes that.

With the watchdog on, 429 and 529 capacity errors retry indefinitely. On v2.1.199 or later, other transient errors get 300 retries, roughly three hours of backoff.

FIG. 3



SCALE · PRODUCTION

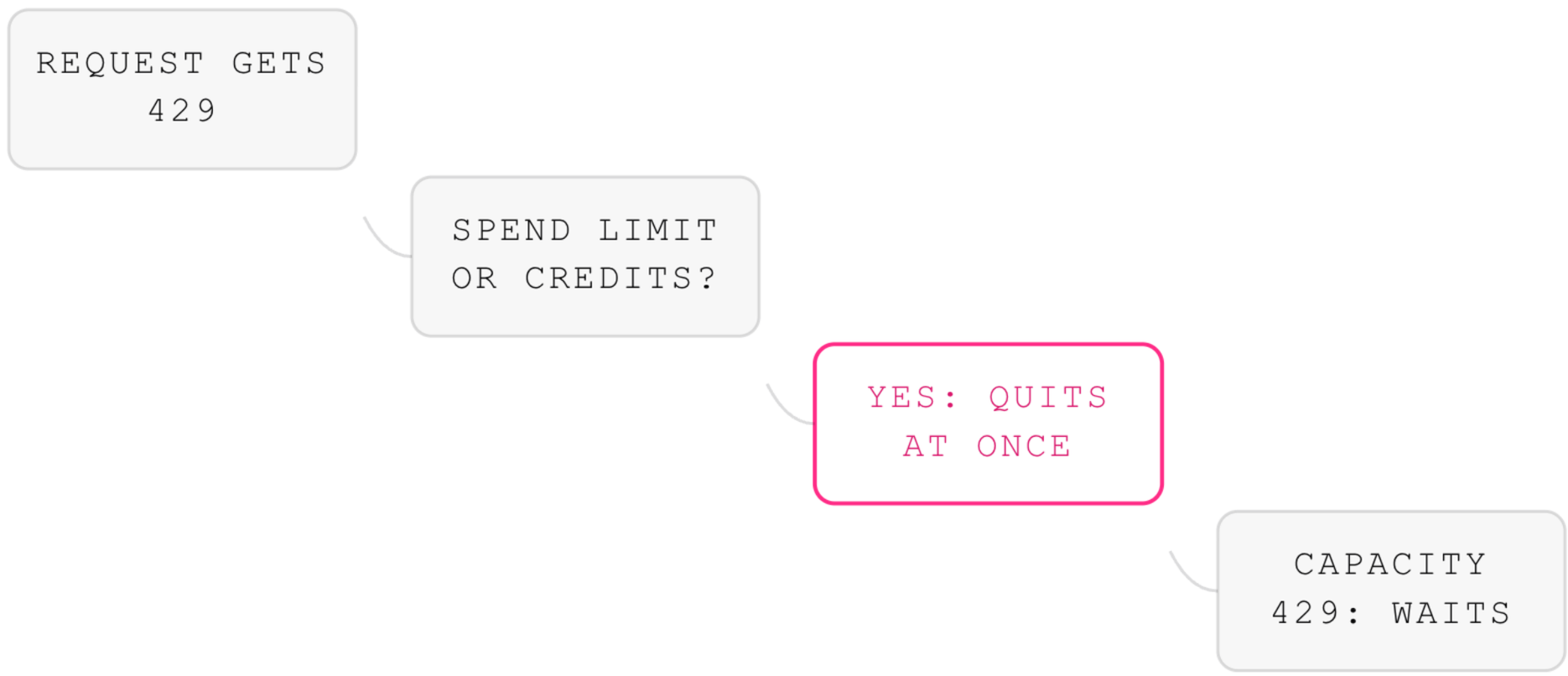
VERYDIAN

SECTION 04 · WAIT OR QUIT

Capacity 429s wait. Spend-limit 429s quit.

A standard-speed 429 that reports a spend limit or exhausted credits fails at once, even one from a gateway spend cap that resets on a schedule.

FIG. 4



SCALE · PRODUCTION

VERYDIAN

SECTION 05 · UNRESOLVED

The docs and the changelog don't fully agree

The changelog's new variable implies the watchdog can wait at some usage limits. Neither the Errors page nor the env-var page mentions it. Test your own boundary.

FIG. 5

ERRORS PAGE

- SPEND LIMIT: QUITS
- NEW VARIABLE UNMENTIONED

VS

CHANGELOG, OCT 15

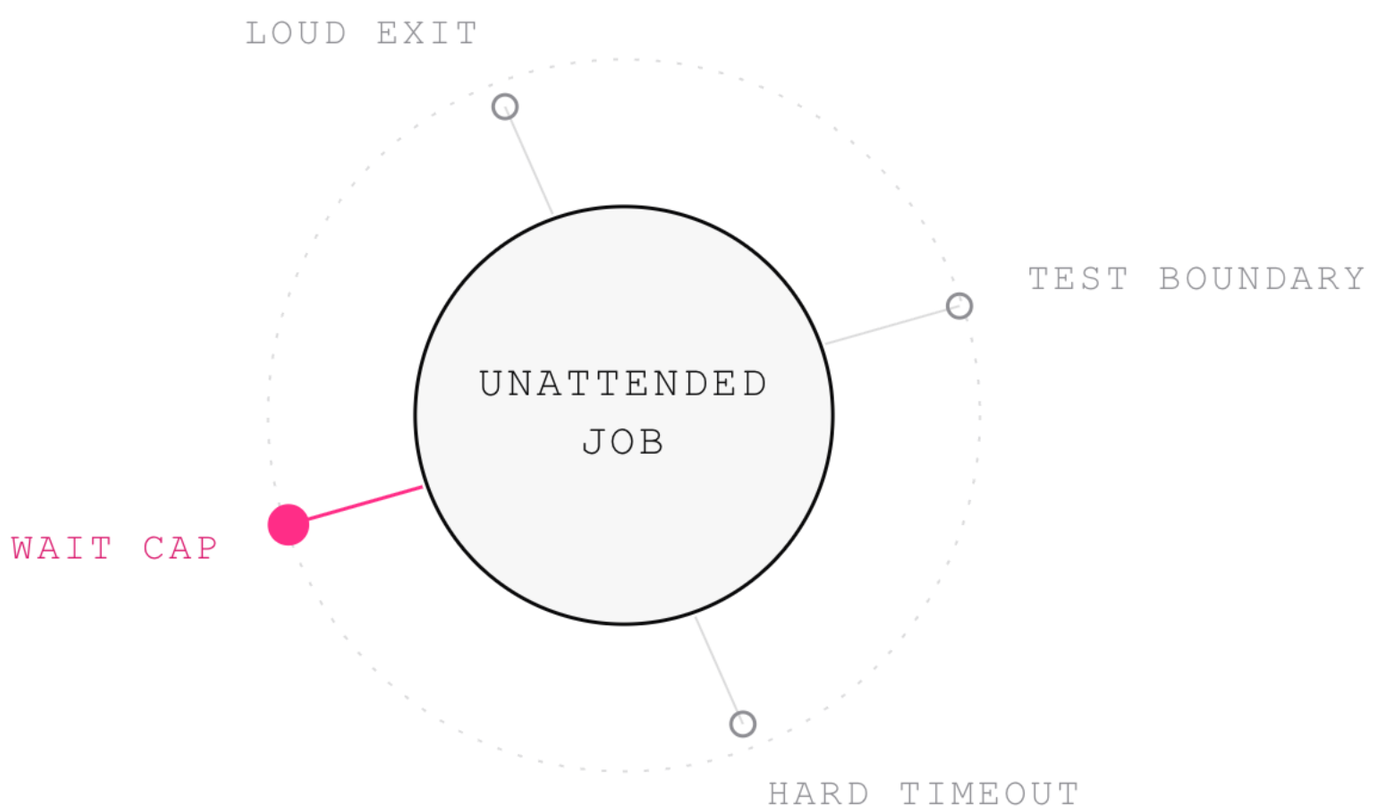
- USAGE-LIMIT WAIT CAP
- IMPLIES IT CAN WAIT

SECTION 06 · THE GUARDS

Give the job a budget for waiting

A retry switch is not a budget. Put a hard timeout around the run, a cap on each wait, and a loud exit when it quits. Then test where your own boundary sits.

FIG. 6



SCALE · PRODUCTION

VERYDIAN



Put a number on the wait

Hard timeout, wait cap, loud exit. Then test your boundary.

TEST YOUR BOUNDARY